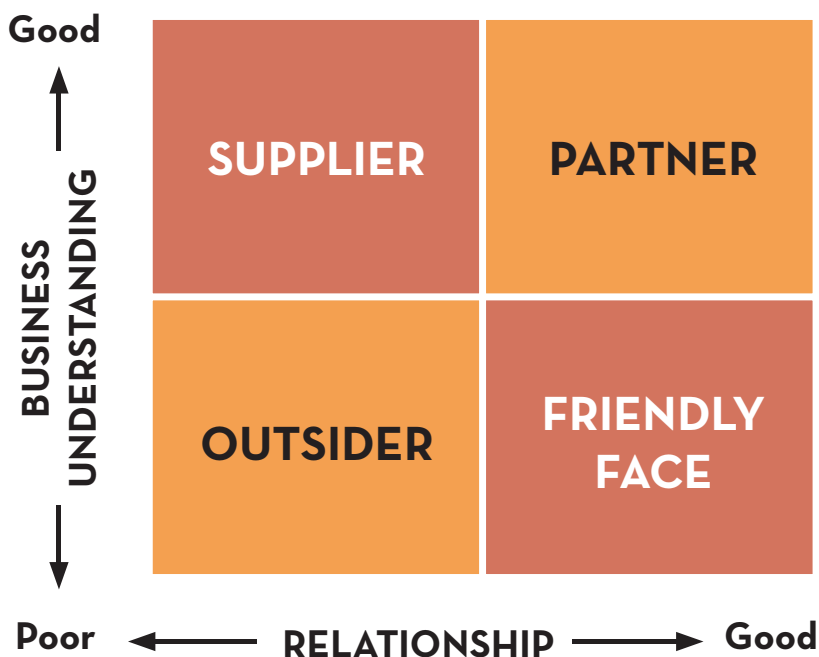


ARE YOU WORKING AS A PARTNER OR SUPPLIER?

Working as an exceptional partner rather than an ordinary supplier is a key area your business should be focusing on.



But how can you measure it?



What would you see, feel or hear to confirm you are going in the right direction with your key accounts?



What if you had a list of 20 indicators that support you in turning this rather subjective question into an objective KPI?



One of the tools we encourage organisations to use is our Partnership Indicators.

Based on the above matrix you need to be top-right and have high relationship management skills and a high level of understanding of the customer's business needs, problems, pressures, priorities, fears and aspirations for the future.

The idea is that you generate 20 statements that would be scored as true or false to give you an overall partnership scoring with your existing key accounts.

PARTNERSHIP INDICATORS

Using our own client experiences from the past 20 years in a variety of business settings our clients have developed 40 examples which we have seen being used in real key account business situations.

The key account tells you that you are a partner.

There is clear evidence of added value and ROI.

You understand their future strategy because you are genuinely interested in their past, present and future.

They give you confidential information.

There are no nasty surprises in the relationship.

Strong multi-level relationships exist.

More sales and profit as time goes by.

They accept your new products and services willingly.

Price resistance drops over time.

They ask for advice, not just on your core offering.

You have a rolling agreement, not a fixed term contract.

Reverse hospitality – i.e. they pay!

They invite you to shape the tender.

Joint action plans are in place.

They give you referrals.

They are happy to feature in your case studies and testimonials.

Two logos appear side by side.

Tolerance is evident in the event of a problem.

Feedback is welcomed and dealt with properly.

They bend the rules to accommodate you.

You are their first point of contact.

Changes in personnel (your or theirs) do not affect the relationship.

You are involved in creating their goals and strategies.

Relationships develop into genuine friendships outside work.

You are copied in on their emails.

You help to train their staff.

Your phone call and meeting requests always granted.

Alignment of plans and timings.

You share the costs and rewards.

They see you as a dotted-line member of their team.

They agree to your ongoing and regular price increases.

They attend your meetings and conferences to provide feedback.

They willingly get involved in your customer research.

Your customer contacts fight your corner in front of their colleagues.

They regard you as the industry expert.

There is culture fit between your two organisations.

They offer you exclusivity.

You have an office or workspace on their premises.

They join your social media networking groups.

They commit, in writing to a long-term relationship.

HOW TO USE THE TOOL:

Take a look through the **40 Partnership Indicators** as a start point and use the list to help you develop a list of your own **20** which are right for you and specific to your business and industry.

Using the 20 indicators you have identified as a checklist calculate your score out of 20 for each key account you work with. Checking through the points will help gauge where you currently stand and where the focus needs to be, to improve your score.

HOW DO YOU MEASURE UP?

Don't forget to use the tool regularly to track your progress and share your wins across the organisation.

WANT MORE BACKGROUND INFO?

This topic is covered in depth in our KAM book: Top 10 Tips For Your Top 10 Customers: Tip two. Download for FREE now to find stories and analogies relating specifically to this tool and more tips on becoming an exceptional partner.

NEED SOME ADVICE?

Jump on a KAMcall with us to chat through your statements.



Jump ahead of your competitors
with more KAM resources at:
www.kamguru.com/resources

